

Lawdger

React Native + Next.js

Development Roadmap

Voice-First Litigation Case Management • Frontend Architecture Guide

0. Tech Stack

The Lawdger frontend is built on two tightly coupled layers: a React Native mobile app for advocates on the move, and a Next.js middleware/API layer that handles auth and database integration.

Category	Technologies
Mobile App	React Native (Expo), TypeScript, React Navigation, Zustand, Axios
Backend / API	Next.js (App Router), API Routes, Authentication, DB Integration

Phase 1 — Project Setup

Timeline: Week 1 | Goal: App skeleton ready

React Native Bootstrap

```
npx create-expo-app lawdger-app

cd lawdger-app && npm install

npm install @react-navigation/native @react-navigation/bottom-tabs zustand axios

npx expo install react-native-screens react-native-safe-area-context
```

Folder Structure

```
/src  
  
  /screens  
  
  /components  
  
  /navigation  
  
  /store  
  
  /services  
  
  /hooks  
  
  /utils
```

Phase 2 — Navigation & Layout

Timeline: Week 1–2 | Goal: App navigation ready

Bottom Tab Navigation

Configure five primary tabs for daily advocate workflow:

- Home
- Tasks
- Calendar
- Chat
- Profile

Screens to Create

- HomeScreen
- CaseDetailScreen
- AddCaseScreen
- TaskScreen
- CalendarScreen
- ProfileScreen

Navigation Files

```
/navigation  
  AppNavigator.tsx  
  TabNavigator.tsx  
  StackNavigator.tsx
```

Phase 3 — Authentication

Timeline: Week 2 | Goal: Secure login system

Features

- Login screen
- Signup screen
- JWT token storage via expo-secure-store

Auth Flow

```
Login → Store JWT Token → Navigate to Main App
```

Phase 4 — Case Management

Timeline: Week 3–4 | Goal: Core app usable

Features

- **Case List**
- Fetch all cases, display list, search cases
- **Add Case**
- Case name, client name, court (optional)
- **Case Detail**
- Show case info, placeholder for notes

Components

- CaseCard
- SearchBar
- EmptyState

API Endpoints (Next.js)

```
GET    /api/cases
POST   /api/cases
GET    /api/cases/:id
```

Phase 5 — Voice UI (Frontend Only)

Timeline: Week 5 | Goal: Voice recording UX (no AI yet)

Features

- Start / stop recording
- Playback audio
- Save recording locally
- Send file to API (Next.js)

Library

```
npx expo install expo-av
```

UI Components

- Floating mic button
- Recording modal with timer + wave indicator
- Cancel / Save actions

Phase 6 — Notes UI

Timeline: Week 6 | Goal: Case timeline UI

Features

- Timeline view inside each case
- Entry types: Note, Task, Date

Components

- TimelineItem
- Tag (Task / Date / Note)
- NoteCard

Phase 7 — Task Management UI

Timeline: Week 7 | Goal: Productivity layer

Features

- Global task list
- Tasks per case
- Mark complete
- Overdue highlighting

Filter Tabs

- All
- Pending
- Completed

Components

- TaskCard
- Checkbox

Phase 8 — Calendar UI

Timeline: Week 8 | Goal: Hearing tracking

Features

- Monthly view or simple agenda list
- Show court events
- Tap event to open related case

Optional Library

```
react-native-calendars
```

Phase 9 — Dashboard

Timeline: Week 9 | Goal: Daily clarity for advocates

Sections

- Today's tasks
- Upcoming hearings
- Recent cases

Components

- SummaryCard
- SectionHeader

Phase 10 — Chat UI (Frontend Only)

Timeline: Week 10 | Goal: AI interface ready

Features

- Chat screen with scrollable message history
- Message bubbles (user / system)
- Input bar with send action

API Endpoint

```
POST /api/chat
```

Components

- ChatBubble (user / system)
- InputBar

Phase 11 — Notifications

Timeline: Week 11 | Goal: Timely reminders

Library

```
expo-notifications
```

Features

- Local push notifications
- Task reminders
- Daily summary

Phase 12 — Settings & Profile

Timeline: Week 12 | Goal: User control

Features

- Logout
- Notification preferences
- Basic user settings

Next.js — Backend / API Layer

Bootstrap

```
npx create-next-app@latest lawdger-api
```

API Structure

```
/app/api
  /auth
    POST /api/auth/login
    POST /api/auth/signup
  /cases
    GET /api/cases
    POST /api/cases
    GET /api/cases/:id
  /notes
    GET /api/notes
    POST /api/notes
  /tasks
    GET /api/tasks
    POST /api/tasks
    PATCH /api/tasks/:id
```

Data Flow

React Native App → Axios → Next.js API → Database

MVP Checklist

Must Build First

- Authentication (login / signup)
- Case CRUD
- Voice recording UI
- Notes UI
- Tasks UI

Can Delay

- Advanced calendar UI
- AI chat streaming
- Notifications polish

Timeline Summary

Estimated total build time: 10–12 weeks for a working MVP.

Phase	Duration
Setup + Navigation	1–2 weeks
Auth + Cases	2 weeks
Voice UI	1 week
Tasks + Notes	2 weeks
Calendar + Dashboard	2 weeks
Chat + Notifications	2 weeks

